

WELCOME · WANSTEAD FELLAS

P526 · INDUCTION

THE NEW-JOINER THREE-PAGER · 26 AUG 2026

Welcome in. You've joined **Wanstead Fellas** — a Thursday-night 8-a-side football group in E11 that's been running since 2020 and grown to ~70 fellas across every age from Under-20s to 50+. What follows is everything you need to know in three pages. Read once, come Thursday.

A Wanstead Fellas Thursday

WHERE

Eton Manor, Wanstead
E11. Astro at the far end.

WHEN

Every Thu · **21:00–22:00**
KO · arrive 20:45.

FORMAT

4-team **8v8** round-robin,
~6 × 20-min games.

BRING

Boots · shirt (any colour)
· water. Bibs supplied.

WHAT A TYPICAL NIGHT LOOKS LIKE

 20:45

Arrive. Teams are already published — check the **Teams** tab in the app on the way over so you know who you're with.

 21:00 →
22:00

Three short games. Every team plays every other team, ~20 mins each, rolling subs. Bibs vs shirts each game.

 22:15+

Drinks in the clubhouse. Optional but recommended — most of the banter for next week's match report gets minted here.

 FRI 10AM

Awards ballot closes. Vote MOTM, DOTD, and (when set) Theme of the Night — winners auto-announced, match report drops with the results.

 **Introduce yourself.** If it's your first night, find **Paul Barham**, **Tom Broughton**, **Edd Ezra**, **Scott Duncan**, **Lawrie Pointer** — or honestly any other fella at pitch-side — and say hello. They'll point out who's who and make sure you know the drill. Everyone else will make themselves known — nobody stays a stranger past the first game.

Under-the-radar rules

Four unwritten ones that the app can't enforce:

- **Play through niggles when you can** — but log real injuries in the app so admin can plan (see p3).
- **Don't be a cunt (and mean it).** There's literally a fine for it — see the Fine System on p3.
- **Buy your round.** On pitch and off it.
- **Bibs go home, get washed, come back.** If you played in bibs, take yours home and wash it — don't chuck it damp into the kit bag. Nobody wants to pull on last week's.

The app — 60-second orientation

The whole club runs off wanstead-fellas.vercel.app. It's a free web app — no App Store, no download. Open the URL, hit "Add to Home Screen" (iPhone Safari) or "Install" (Android Chrome) and you're set. It'll behave like a proper app after that.

FIRST FIVE MINUTES

- 1 **Sign up** with your email + password.
- 2 **Fill your Profile** — photo, name, age band, preferred position (GK / DEF / MID / ATT), preferred foot, favourite club. Two minutes.
- 3 **Enable notifications** — the one-tap toggle on Profile. How you'll hear about teams being published, match reports going live, and dropouts.
- 4 **Sign up for Thursday** — **Tonight** tab → "Mark Me In". Deadline is **Wednesday 10pm**.
- 5 **Have a poke around** the other tabs — **Cards**, **History**, **Predictor**. All will make more sense after your first Thursday.

THE TABS, IN ONE LINE EACH

 Tonight Sign up. See who else is in. Countdown to kick-off. Weather. The injury list.	 Teams Published after Wednesday 10pm. Your team is highlighted; captains and bibs shown.	 Match Latest result, group table, scorers, match report, awards ballot.	 Stats Season leaderboards — top scorers, MOTM count, appearances, clean sheets.	 Predictor Free-to-play — pick the score of a weekly PL/ Championship game (Match of the Week) or fill in a full-season prediction card. Bragging rights only.	... More · then Cards, History, Help, Feedback Your player card is under Cards. Past match reports under History. Stuck? Help articles + a Feedback tab straight to admin.
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The two things that trip new joiners up: (1) **Notifications not enabled** — you'll miss the "teams are ready" ping and the match report drop. Fix it once on Profile. (2) **Not adding a photo** — cards look drab, and the group can't put a face to your name. Takes 5 seconds.

💷 Costs and player tiers

Three tiers, priority in this order when the game oversubscribes (max 32/night):

SUB

£95 / season

Full season paid up front.
Guaranteed spot every week. Most regular players are on this.

WTP★

£5 / game

Long-standing "Wait To Play" players with priority — bumped up ahead of standard WTP when spots are tight.

WTP

£5 / game

Pay-as-you-play. Fill remaining spots on a first-come basis. Most new joiners start here.

Fees are tracked in-app under [Profile → My Finances](#). Pay by bank transfer (details are on the Finances page). Grace period is 2 weeks past a match — beyond that, unpaid balances block future sign-ups until settled.

📋 Sign-up rules

Sign up: Tonight tab → [Mark Me In](#). **Deadline: Wednesday 10pm.** Teams get auto-balanced and published minutes later.

💷 The Fine System

£2

NOT ON TIME FOR KICK-OFF
(9:10PM LATEST)

£3

LOSING A BALL
OVER THE ALLOTMENTS

£5

CALLING SOMEONE A C**T
(AND MEANING IT)

Settle monthly, straight into the kitty. Failure to settle amounts owed will result in a **one-match ban** until it's cleared. For the avoidance of doubt: this isn't a money-making scheme — it's to keep kick-off on time, cut the ball-replacement bill, and remind everyone it's a kickabout (and a beer) with likeminded people from the local area.

▶ OTHER POINTS TO NOTE

- **No slide tackles.**
- **Calling Ross a c*nt and not meaning it** is a permitted exception (see fine above for the meaning-it case).
- **No Mags.** Might be pushing this one, but worth a try. 😊

🏆 Awards, injury list & the rest

🏆 **Awards.** After every match: **Man of the Match** (best on the pitch) and **Dick of the Day** (least — usually a spectacular own-goal, air-kick or full-blown meltdown). Occasional themed award set by admin (Kevin Keegan tribute, Italian football, etc.). Voting closes 10am Friday; winners auto-announced.

🩹 **Injury list.** Picked up a knock? Profile → [Mark myself injured](#) → pick a type + when you're back. The group sees a "🩹 On the injury list" strip on the Tonight tab so nobody chases you for numbers. Play through niggles if you can — the app [warns](#) if you sign up while marked injured, but doesn't block.

💬 **WhatsApp vs the app.** WhatsApp for banter and last-minute shouts. App for anything with a deadline (sign-ups, votes, fines, predictor). Admin lives in the app; the group chat is the pub.

Any questions: Feedback tab in the app goes straight to Paul. Category "General" if you're not sure. Zero-friction, no reply expected within any particular window — but it never goes unread.



SEE YOU THURSDAY · PITCH AT 21:00 · WELCOME TO THE FELLAS